A Report on Women Head Coaches at NCAA D-I Institutions with Career Longevit of 20+ Years

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PRIMARY AIM OF STUDY

The purposes of this study are to empirically examine which women have occupied a Head Coaching position for an NCAA Division-I level women's sports team for a continuous 20 years or longer and to assess which supports allow women to thrive in collegiate coaching.

INTRODUCTION

All women Head Coaches with a career longevity of over 20 years at the NCAA Division-I level were identified through an online search. Each coaches profile information was compiled and nine factors were considered: 1. coaches age, 2. coaches race, 3. coaches career duration, 4. coaches alma mater, 5. sport they coach, 6. institution at which the coach currently works, 7. endowment of the institution at which they work, 8. conference in which they coach, 9. coaches career win-loss record.





6,632 NCAA D-I Head Coaches	2,029 D-I Women Head Coaches	214 Women Coaches of 20+ Years

LITERATURE REVIEW

While Title IX had a positive effect on the number of girls participating in sport, it had a significant, negative effect on the percentage of women in coaching; Today, women coaches women are under-represented in almost every sport (Acosta & Carpenter, 2014), at every level of competition (Robertson, 2010), at every type of institution (LaVoi, 2017). This stagnation in the number of women coaches begs the questions: *who are the women that stay* and *what factors allowed them to do so?*

Empirical research on women coaches over the last 45 years is powerful with respect to generalizability; however, large scale quantitative studies invariably disregard outliers, such as women who have stayed in the profession. The most comprehensive qualitative summation of factors that influence women coaches career trajectories is the *Ecological Model of Barriers and Supports for Female Coaches* (LaVoi & Dutove, 2012). Since, scholarship on factors that influence coaches' career trajectories and coaches' decision-making have emerged, offering new ways of studying women coaches (Callary, Werthner, & Trudel, 2012; Denison, Mills, & Konoval, 2017; Kinnaird, 2016; Thorpe, 2010; Weatherford, 2017).

Extending LaVoi and Dutove's (2012) model by utilizing recent scholarship, this paper offers three points of departure from the current literature. First, it studies the women who have stayed in the profession for markedly longer than their peers. Second, it examines factors at that influence the retention of women in coaching. Third, it uses new qualitative theoretical and methodological approaches to do so.

METHOD

Data for this report was collected between November 15, 2017 and January 15, 2018 by visiting each institution's athletics website and reviewing the coaching staff for the 2017-2018 academic year of every women's NCAA-sponsored and emerging team in the U.S.

Each individual listed on the coaching roster as Head Coach or Associate Head Coach was recorded. Head coaches of Track and Field (T&F) and Cross Country (CC) were coded separately from Head T&F and Head CC coaches. Individuals who occupied positions across multiple sports throughout their career were coded with their most recent sport. The dataset included all head coaches of women's teams (N = 7208) at 353 institutions of higher education. Biographical information on each coach was also recorded.

KEY FINDINGS

Factor 1: Coaches Age

The average age of the coaches from this sample was 53.7 years old with the oldest coach being 78 years old and the youngest being 41 years old.

Factor 2: Coaches Race / Ethnicity

The race / ethnicity of the coaches in this sample varied with 93.6% (n = 200) being white, 4.2% (n = 9) being black, 1.8% being other women of color (n = 4), and with 0.4% (n = 1) being Asian American.

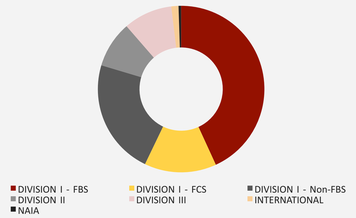
Factor 3: Coaches Career Duration

The average duration of the coaches careers from this sample was 26.1 years with the longest career being 46 years and the shortest being 20 years.

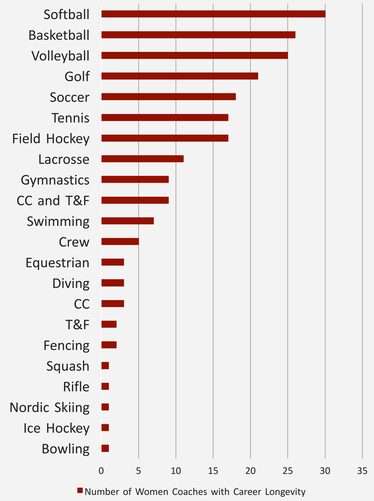
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KEY FINDINGS

Factor 4: Coaches Alma Mater Type



Factor 5: Sport Coached



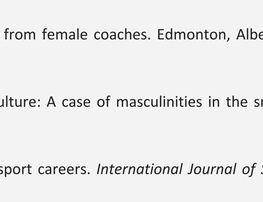
Factor 6: Institutional Affiliation

# Women with Career Longevity	Institution(s)
7	Harvard University
5	UCLA
4	Boston University, Duke, Michigan State, Princeton, U.S. Naval Academy, UC Berkeley
3	Brown, Dartmouth, LSU, The Ohio State, University of Akron, University of Florida, University of Michigan, University of New Hampshire, UNC Chapel Hill
2	Arizona State University, Boston College, Bryant, Cornell, Fairfield, Fordham, George Washington, Lehigh, Monmouth, Oklahoma Stat Penn State, Pepperdine, Quinnipiac, Sacred Heart, SMU, Temple, Texas State, UNC Charlotte, University of Central Arkansas, Univer of Central Florida, UConn, University of Illinois Chicago, University Nebraska, University of North Florida, Notre Dame, USC Columbia Knoxville, UVA, University of Washington, Villanova, Wake Forest

Factor 7: Institutional Endowment

Using a sub-set of 40 institutions, ther was a positive correlation of .672 between institution endowment and number of coaches with career longevi

Factor 8: Conference Affiliation Type



Factor 9: Win-Loss Record

The average win-loss record of the coaches from this sample was .615 with the lowest career record being .385 and the highest being .886.

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